

Fiserv Inc. (FI): First Take: Miss on merchant revenue ex clover and as well as merchant margins; trims outlook

Bottom line: FI reported a 2% EPS beat largely driven by a lower tax rate, as operating income was in-line, due to much lower than expected margins in merchant offsetting a small beat on the top line (driven by Financial Solutions). In addition, the company reduced its organic growth guidance from 10-12% to roughly 10%, and increased the low end of the EPS guide reflecting the small beat in the quarter. The company also reduced its adjusted revenue guide by roughly 1%, excluding the slight benefit from FX movements (FX related impacts in the organic growth guide improved by 50bp, adjusted rev guide down 50bps). So net net, the company reduced both organic revenue and adjusted revenue by ~1% at the midpoint, and reduced the margin expansion guide to ~100bps from >125bps. Clover volumes came in roughly in-line with company commentary, and the company reiterated their expectations for double digit reported growth in 2H, with an underlying runrate of 12%+ ex the headwind from gateway. So overall, we thought the Clover numbers were more or less in-line with expectations, although the gateway headwinds appear to be a bit larger than previously understood, both in 2Q and 2H. The miss appears to be coming from both small business ex clover and the enterprise segment. While we can't be sure, we would call out both the margin miss and the revenue miss in SMB ex Clover and Enterprise, which, taken together, could imply headwinds from the company's Latin American / business where the company earns high margin revenue from merchant advance revenue that is sensitive to macro/interest rates (we look for more color on whether this was a driver on the call). So overall, we would expect the stock to underperform on the miss on merchant revs and the margin miss. However, we see the Clover numbers as more or less in-line with expectations, particularly with the company reiterating all of their prior commentary around the double digit volumes in the second half of the year on a reported basis.

What we are looking for on the call: 1) How is the company thinking about the 2026 revenue target for Clover in light of the lower volume growth, 2) what is driving the lower revenue and margins in the merchant segment given Clover revs are coming in-line with expectations, 3) color on the strength in issuing solutions, 4) commentary on the strategic partnership with TD and the acquisition of their acquiring business in Canada.

Consolidated results: FI reported 2Q25 adjusted revenue of ~\$5.20bn, in line with

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Visible Alpha Consensus Data expectations of \$5.18bn, with 8% revenue growth (8% organic), including ~9.7% in Merchant Solutions (9% organic) and ~7.3% in Financial Solutions (7% organic). Adjusted operating income was in line with street expectations at ~\$2.059bn vs ~\$2.050bn consensus, with a ~39.6% operating margin (in line with consensus, 39.6%). FI posted adjusted EPS of \$2.47, ahead of \$2.43 consensus.

Operating dynamics:

- **Merchant Solutions:** Merchant Solutions revenue was in line with the Street at ~\$2.644bn (vs VA consensus of \$2.652bn), increasing ~9.7% yoy (9% organic). Operating income for the quarter was up ~4% yoy, coming in at \$914mn vs the Street at \$990mn, driving margins ~280bps below the Street at ~34.6% (vs ~37.3%).
 - **Clover GPV** was up 8% (8% in 1Q25), with 30% revenue growth (27% growth last quarter).
 - **Small business** revenue growth was 11% (9% organic) coming in at ~\$1.774bn (1% below expectations).
 - **Enterprise** revenue growth was ~8% (12% organic) coming in at ~\$587bn (2% below the Street).
 - **Processing** revenue came in at roughly \$283mn (4% ahead of Street estimates).
- **Financial Solutions:** Financial solutions adjusted revenue came in 1% above the street at \$2.552bn (vs VA consensus of \$2,523bn), increasing ~7.3% yoy (7% organically). Operating income for the quarter was up ~14% yoy, coming in at \$1.244bn (+4% vs the Street), with margins coming in ~130bps ahead of the Street at 48.7% (vs VA of 47.4%).
 - **Banking** revenue growth was ~0% reported and organic, coming in at \$625mn, -3% vs Street expectations.
 - **Digital Payments** grew 6% (6% organic), coming in at \$1,051mn or -1% vs Street expectations.
 - **Issuing** was up 14% yoy on a reported basis, up 13% organic and coming in at \$876mn (+7% vs VA consensus).
- **Corporate & other:** Corporate & other adjusted revenue came in at ~\$0mn. Adjusted operating income for the quarter came in at -\$99mn.

Guidance: FI adjusted its revenue and EPS guidance for FY2025, with expectations for organic revenue growth to be ~10% (from 10-12% previously) and 10% (9.5%-11.5% previously) adjusted revenue growth with ~1.0% FX headwind (from ~1.5%) and acquisition tailwinds of 1%. Adjusted operating margin expansion is expected to be ~100bps (from 125+ bps). On EPS, the company increased expectations for adjusted EPS to \$10.15-\$10.30 (from \$10.10-\$10.30), implying 15-17% growth (unch). FCF is expected to be more than ~\$5.5bn (unch), implying FCF conversion of ~96.7% based on EPS guidance and consensus share count (compared to consensus FCF conversion of ~95.5%). Finally, 2025 amortization expense of acquired intangibles is expected to

decrease roughly 5% (unch) from 2024 levels.

Exhibit 1: 2025 FI Estimates vs Actuals

\$ in millions, unless noted

FI estimates vs. actuals		Actual	Actual	Actual	GS est.	Cons. est.	Act vs GS	Act vs cons	QoQ	YoY	Comments
		2Q24	1Q25	2Q25A	2Q25	2Q25	% Δ	% Δ	2Q/1Q	25/24	
Adjusted Revenue	Clover Volume	78	74	84	85	86	-1%	-2%	14%	8%	
	% YoY growth	17%	8%	8%	9%	10%	-90 bps	-275 bps	-36 bps	-956 bps	
	Clover Revenue Growth	28%	27%	30%	27%	28%	300 bps		300 bps	200 bps	
	Small business	1,604	1,594	1,774	1,816	1,790	-2%	-1%	11%	11%	
	% YoY Growth	13%	7%	10.6%	13%	12%	-262 bps	-98 bps	348 bps	-204 bps	
	% Organic growth, yoy	35%	10%	9.0%	12%	13%	-331 bps	-360 bps	-74 bps	-2611 bps	
	Enterprise	542	502	587	574	600	2%	-2%	17%	8%	
	% YoY Growth	9%	8%	8.3%	6%	11%	247 bps	-238 bps	-12 bps	-119 bps	
	% Organic growth, yoy	27%	12%	12.0%	8%	13%	400 bps	-133 bps	12 bps	-1527 bps	
	Processing	264	276	283	254	271	11%	4%	3%	7%	
	% YoY Growth	-8%	-9%	7.2%	-4%	3%	1087 bps	437 bps	1581 bps	1521 bps	
	% Organic growth, yoy	-7%	-7%	5.0%	-2%	4%	700 bps	131 bps	1162 bps	1232 bps	
	Merchant Solutions	2,410	2,372	2,644	2,644	2,652	0%	0%	11%	10%	
	% YoY Growth	9%	5%	9.7%	10%	10%	1 bps	-33 bps	443 bps	46 bps	
	% Organic growth, yoy	28%	8%	9.0%	10%	12%	-78 bps	-292 bps	101 bps	-1883 bps	
	Banking	626	608	625	632	643	-1%	-3%	3%	0%	
	% YoY Growth	4%	1%	-0.2%	1%	3%	-116 bps	-280 bps	-82 bps	-380 bps	
	% Organic growth, yoy	4%	1%	0.0%	1%	3%	-100 bps	-260 bps	-66 bps	-364 bps	
	Digital payments	987	995	1,051	1,056	1,057	0%	-1%	6%	6%	
	% YoY Growth	8%	8%	6.5%	7%	7%	-52 bps	-59 bps	-167 bps	-186 bps	
	% Organic growth, yoy	8%	8%	6.0%	7%	7%	-100 bps	-111 bps	-215 bps	-234 bps	
	Issuing	766	814	876	818	821	7%	7%	8%	14%	
	% YoY Growth	4%	7%	14.4%	7%	7%	754 bps	717 bps	740 bps	1014 bps	
	% Organic growth, yoy	10%	8%	13.0%	5%	7%	800 bps	577 bps	538 bps	348 bps	
	Financial Solutions	2,379	2,417	2,552	2,507	2,523	2%	1%	6%	7%	
	% YoY Growth	6%	6%	7.3%	5%	6%	191 bps	122 bps	149 bps	154 bps	
	% Organic growth, yoy	7%	6%	7.0%	5%	6%	222 bps	100 bps	100 bps	-47 bps	
	Corporate & other	5	0	0	3	3	-100%	-100%	NA	-100%	
	Adjusted Revenue	4,794	4,789	5,196	5,154	5,178	1%	0%	8%	8%	
	% YoY Growth	7%	5%	8.4%	7%	8%	89 bps	38 bps	298 bps	97 bps	
	% Organic growth, yoy	18%	7%	8%	7%	8%	65 bps	-41 bps	101 bps	-955 bps	
Non-GAAP Operating Income	Merchant Solutions	882	810	914	977	990	-6%	-8%	13%	4%	
	% margin	36.6%	34.1%	34.6%	36.9%	37.3%	-237 bps	-276 bps	42 bps	-203 bps	
	Financial Solutions	1,093	1,148	1,244	1,207	1,197	3%	4%	8%	14%	
	% margin	45.9%	47.5%	48.7%	48.2%	47.4%	59 bps	131 bps	125 bps	281 bps	
	Corporate & other	-134	-150	-99	-130	-136	-24%	-27%	-34%	-26%	
Adjusted Operating income		1,841	1,808	2,059	2,054	2,050	0%	0%	14%	12%	
	% margin	38.4%	37.8%	39.6%	39.9%	39.6%	-22 bps	3 bps	188 bps	123 bps	
Other	Other expense / (income)	287	334	388	369	363	5%	7%	16%	35%	
Non-GAAP Pre-tax	Pre-tax income	1,554	1,474	1,671	1,685	1,687	-1%	-1%	13%	8%	
Taxes	Income tax expense	309	264	319	333	339	-4%	-6%	21%	3%	
	Effective tax rate	20%	18%	19%	20%	20%	-66 bps	-98 bps	118 bps	-79 bps	
Equity income	Equity income/minority interest	-23	-5	12	-10	8	-220%	42%	-340%	-152%	Net of income attributable to NCI
Adj Net income	Non-GAAP Net income	1,245	1,210	1,364	1,352	1,357	1%	1%	13%	10%	
Shares	Average diluted shares	585	565	553	555	559	0%	-1%	-2%	-6%	
Non-GAAP EPS	Earnings per share, diluted	2.13	2.14	2.47	2.44	2.43	1%	2%	15%	16%	
Cash Flow	Share repurchases	1,556	2,352	\$2,290	\$1,750	\$1,394	31%	64%	-3%	47%	
	Capex	-348	-335	-479	-399	-392	20%	22%	43%	38%	
	Adjusted Free Cash Flow	1,025	371	1174	1,375	1,343	-15%	-13%	216%	15%	
	FCF Conversion	82%	31%	86%	102%	99%	-15%	-13%	181%	5%	
Operating Metrics	Small Business Volume Growth, % yoy	4%	3%	9%					600 bps	500 bps	
	Enterprise Transaction Growth, % yoy	8%	13%	14%					100 bps	600 bps	

Source: Visible Alpha Consensus Data, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: 2025 FI Guidance vs Consensus

\$ in millions, unless noted

2025 Guide	Cons. est	Low	Mid	High	Low	Mid	High	Notes
GAAP Revenue	22,172	22,502	22,706	22,911	1%	2%	3%	
% Growth, yoy	8.4%	10.0%	11.0%	12.0%	161bps	261bps	361bps	
Adjusted Revenue	20,779	21,035	21,035	21,035	1%	1%	1%	
% Growth, yoy	8.7%	10.0%	10.0%	10.0%	134bps	134bps	134bps	
% FX Impact		1.0%	1.0%	1.0%				
% Acquisition adjustments		-1.0%	-1.0%	-1.0%				
% Divestiture adjustments		0.0%	0.0%	0.0%				
% Organic Revenue Growth	9.1%	10.0%	10.0%	10.0%	88bps	88bps	88bps	
Adjusted Operating income	8,450	8,501	8,501	8,501	1%	1%	1%	
% Margin	40.7%	40.4%	40.4%	40.4%	-25bps	-25bps	-25bps	
% Expansion YoY	0bps	100bps	100bps	100bps				~100bps
Adjusted EPS	10.20	10.15	10.23	10.30	-1%	0%	1%	
% Growth, yoy	15.9%	15%	16%	17%	-59bps	27bps	112bps	
Free Cash Flow	5,422	5,500	5,500	5,500	1%	1%	1%	~\$5.5bn
% FCF Conversion	95.5%	97.4%	96.7%	96.0%	187bps	116bps	45bps	
Guidance								
Variance								
Implied 2H25 Guide	Cons. est	Low	Mid	High	Low	Mid	High	Notes
GAAP Revenue	11,525	11,856	12,307	12,512	3%	7%	9%	
% Growth, yoy	10.1%	13.3%	16.4%	19.5%	316bps	629bps	943bps	
Adjusted Revenue	10,813	11,050	11,050	11,050	2%	2%	2%	
% Growth, yoy	10.5%	12.9%	12.9%	12.9%	243bps	243bps	243bps	
Adjusted Operating income	4,592	4,634	4,634	4,634	1%	1%	1%	
% Margin	42.5%	41.9%	41.9%	41.9%	-53bps	-53bps	-53bps	
% Expansion YoY	0bps	38bps	38bps	38bps				
Adjusted EPS	5.64	5.54	5.61	5.69	-2%	0%	1%	
% Growth, yoy	17.2%	15.1%	16.7%	18.2%	-205bps	-49bps	106bps	
Free Cash Flow	3703	3,955	3,955	3,955	7%	7%	7%	
% FCF Conversion	119.2%	129.6%	127.9%	126.2%	1039bps	866bps	697bps	

Source: Visible Alpha Consensus Data, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Our 12-month price target for FI at \$208 is based on a 17x multiple on our Q5-Q8 EPS estimates. Key downside risks include weaker macro environment, regulation, and competition.

FI	12m Price Target: \$208.00	Price: \$165.98	Upside: 25.3%
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Buy		GS Forecast				
		12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E	
Market cap: \$92.1bn		Revenue (\$ mn)	19,123.0	20,808.2	22,440.3	24,005.6
Enterprise value: \$118.7bn		EBITDA (\$ mn)	9,677.0	10,478.9	11,370.1	12,392.8
3m ADTV: \$909.2mn		EBIT (\$ mn)	7,537.0	8,506.3	9,404.5	10,292.3
United States		EPS (\$)	8.80	10.34	12.07	14.10
Americas Payments and Financial		P/E (X)	19.0	16.1	13.7	11.8
Technology		EV/EBITDA (X)	12.5	11.3	10.0	8.8
M&A Rank: 3		FCF yield (%)	5.2	5.5	6.9	8.2
		Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
		Net debt/EBITDA (X)	2.4	2.5	2.3	2.1

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 22 Jul 2025 close.

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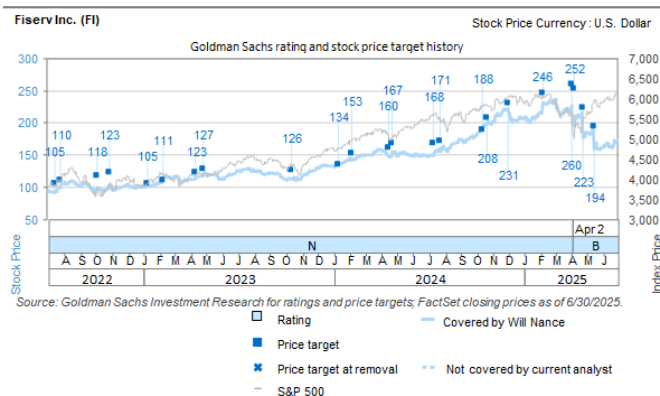
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